Conflict of Interest Statement

Manuscript: Does Rubric-Guided Refinement Improve Automatically Optimized Prompts? A Pre-Specified Negative-Result Study (revised submission; first submission Access-2026-44920)

None of the authors (Linh Nguyen, Quang-Vinh Dang, Minh Ngoc Dinh and Thuy Nguyen) has a conflict of interest to disclose. The same statement appears in the manuscript under "Declaration of Competing Interest".